

Student Resource Guide

Section 1 | Lecture 4: What Makes This Course EXCEPTIONAL

CompTIA SecAI+ Certification Course

1. Overview

This guide maps the complete SecAI+ course roadmap — all 26 sections across four exam domains plus bonus content — and catalogues every learning tool included. Understanding the full journey ahead lets you study with intentionality, track progress by domain, and leverage every resource available.

2. Full Course Structure — Domains and Sections

Domain	Weight	Sections	Core Topics
Domain 1 — AI Fundamentals	14%	2–6	AI concepts, ML types, neural networks, model lifecycle, data preprocessing
Domain 2 — AI Security Operations	29%	7–13	Threat modelling, vulnerability management, incident response, monitoring, data protection
Domain 3 — AI Attack Vectors & Defence	38%	14–21	Data poisoning, adversarial ML, prompt injection, model theft, supply chain, compensating controls
Domain 4 — Governance, Risk & Compliance	19%	22–26	Governance frameworks, responsible AI, risk management, NIST AI RMF, EU AI Act, ISO standards
Bonus Sections	Beyond exam	Throughout	AI security tools, low-code automation, CI/CD security, quantum threats, federated learning

3. Domain 1 — AI Fundamentals (Sections 2–6)

These sections build the conceptual foundation required to understand every subsequent domain. Coverage includes AI concepts and terminology, the distinction between machine learning, deep learning, and generative AI, supervised versus unsupervised versus reinforcement learning, neural networks and transformer architectures, the AI model lifecycle from development through deployment, and data types, quality standards, and preprocessing essentials.

Why this matters for the exam: Domain 1 accounts for 14 percent of the exam (~13 questions), but its concepts appear as prerequisites in Domain 2, 3, and 4 questions. Weakness in Domain 1 creates cascading difficulty across all other domains.

4. Domain 2 — AI Security Operations (Sections 7–13)

These sections develop practitioner skills for securing AI systems in production. Coverage includes securing AI infrastructure and cloud environments, threat modelling for AI systems, vulnerability management within ML pipelines, incident detection, response, and recovery for AI-related breaches,

monitoring and logging AI system activities, adversarial testing and red teaming methodologies, and data protection throughout the AI lifecycle.

Key Insight: Domain 2 (29% weight, ~26 questions) tests whether you can operate as an AI security practitioner. Focus on process and procedure: how threats are detected, how incidents are escalated, and how vulnerabilities are tracked in ML pipelines.

5. Domain 3 — AI Attack Vectors and Defence (Sections 14–21)

The highest-weighted domain at 38 percent (~34 questions). Coverage spans both offensive and defensive perspectives.

Attack Category	Examples Covered
Data-Level Attacks	Data poisoning, backdoor injection, training data manipulation
Model-Level Attacks	Model poisoning, adversarial examples, model inversion, membership inference
Inference-Time Attacks	Prompt injection, jailbreaking, evasion attacks
Intellectual Property Attacks	Model theft, model extraction, API scraping
Supply Chain Attacks	Third-party model compromise, pipeline infiltration
Defences and Controls	Compensating controls, guardrails, access controls, input sanitisation, encryption

6. Domain 4 — Governance, Risk, and Compliance (Sections 22–26)

These sections develop the governance expertise required for AI security leadership roles. Coverage includes organisational governance frameworks for AI, roles and responsibilities across AI security teams, responsible AI principles (fairness, transparency, accountability, explainability), risk management frameworks and methodologies, compliance with OECD AI Principles, NIST AI Risk Management Framework (AI RMF), EU AI Act, and ISO/IEC 42001, corporate policy development, sensitive data governance, third-party AI evaluations, and data sovereignty considerations.

7. Bonus Sections — Beyond the Exam

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8. Learning Tools — The Course Arsenal

Tool	What It Contains	Best Use
Student Resource Guides	Deep-dive notes, tables, callouts, glossary, 20 MCQs per lecture	Post-lecture review and exam prep
Section Quizzes	5 scenario-based MCQs per section with explanations	Test understanding immediately after each section
Practice Exams	Full-length timed exams simulating real conditions	Phases 3 and 4 of study plan
Flashcards	Essential terms and framework acronyms	Daily spaced repetition for memorisation
Performance Tracking	Domain-level score breakdown	Identify and remediate weak domains

9. Why This Course Differs from Competitors

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10. Analogy — The Course as a Navigation System

Think of the SecAI+ certification as a destination and this course as a detailed navigation system. The 26 sections are the roads — each leads from where you are to where you need to be. The domain breakdown shows you the terrain ahead. The learning tools are your GPS, compass, and fuel stops. You can reach the destination with just a map, but the combination of map, navigation, and checkpoints (quizzes and practice exams) ensures you arrive with confidence and efficiency.

11. Quick Revision Checklist

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12. Key Terms Glossary

Term	Definition
NIST AI RMF	National Institute of Standards and Technology AI Risk Management Framework — a voluntary framework for managing AI-related risks.
EU AI Act	European Union regulation classifying AI systems by risk level and imposing compliance requirements based on risk category.
ISO/IEC 42001	International standard for AI management systems, specifying requirements for responsible development and use of AI.
Responsible AI	The practice of developing and deploying AI systems that are fair, transparent, accountable, and explainable.
Federated Learning	A machine learning approach where models are trained across decentralised data sources without centralising the data.
CI/CD Pipeline	Continuous Integration/Continuous Deployment — automated processes for building, testing, and deploying software, including AI models.
MLOps	Machine Learning Operations — the practice of deploying, monitoring, and maintaining ML models in production.
Data Sovereignty	The concept that data is subject to the laws and governance frameworks of the country in which it is collected or processed.

20 Exam-Based MCQs — Course Roadmap and Learning Tools

Test yourself after reading. These questions are written in real exam style — scenario-heavy, with plausible distractors. Read every explanation, including for questions you answered correctly.

Q1. A student begins the SecAI+ course but skips Sections 2–6 (Domain 1 — AI Fundamentals) because they feel familiar with basic AI. What is the most likely consequence?

- A) No consequence — Domain 1 is tested independently and does not affect other domain performance
- B) They will struggle with Domain 2, 3, and 4 content because those domains assume foundational AI knowledge
- C) They will miss 14% of exam content but can compensate by scoring perfectly on Domain 3
- D) CompTIA will prevent them from sitting the exam without evidence of AI fundamentals study

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct Answer: B

Why Correct: Domain 1 concepts — AI model types, training processes, ML architectures — appear as assumed knowledge in Domain 2, 3, and 4. Skipping Domain 1 creates comprehension gaps across the entire course.

Why Wrong: A — Domain dependencies mean Domain 1 weaknesses cascade into other domains. C — Scoring perfectly on Domain 3 requires understanding AI models, which is Domain 1 content. D — CompTIA does not gatekeep exam registration based on study completion.

Learning Insight: Foundational domains are not optional even when their exam weighting is low. Domain 1 is the scaffolding on which all other AI security knowledge rests.

Q2. Which of the following accurately describes how Student Resource Guides are most effectively used in a study plan?

- A) As a replacement for watching lectures — reading the guide is sufficient for exam preparation
- B) Immediately before the exam as a last-minute cramming resource
- C) After each lecture for deep review, reinforcing concepts with the included MCQs and glossary
- D) Only during Phase 1 of study when foundational concepts are being introduced

Answer: C **Explanation:** Correct Answer: C

Why Correct: Student Resource Guides are designed as post-lecture review tools. They expand on lecture content, provide structured notes and MCQs, and reinforce retention through active recall immediately after the lecture.

Why Wrong: A — Guides supplement lectures; they assume lecture concepts as context. B — Last-minute cramming is less effective than spaced review throughout the study period. D — Guides are available for every lecture across all 26 sections.

Learning Insight: The most effective use is the review-test-reinforce cycle: watch the lecture, read the guide, complete the MCQs, note gaps, revisit the lecture for misunderstood concepts.

Q3. A candidate wants to understand how adversaries use AI to enhance cyberattacks, beyond the standard exam objectives. Which course component directly addresses this?

- A) Domain 3 core sections on AI attack vectors
- B) Bonus sections covering AI-enhanced attack vectors and emerging threats
- C) Domain 2 sections on AI security operations
- D) Domain 4 sections on governance and compliance frameworks

Answer: B Explanation: Correct Answer: B

Why Correct: Bonus sections specifically cover AI-enhanced attack vectors (how adversaries weaponise generative AI and LLMs), emerging threats such as quantum computing risks, and practical job-ready skills beyond the SecAI+ exam objectives.

Why Wrong: A — Domain 3 core sections cover attacks against AI systems, not how adversaries use AI as a weapon. C — Domain 2 focuses on defending and operating AI security systems. D — Domain 4 covers policy, governance, and compliance, not offensive AI techniques.

Learning Insight: The distinction between 'attacks on AI' (exam content) and 'attacks using AI' (bonus content) matters for career preparation. Both are increasingly relevant in real security operations roles.

Q4. A candidate reviews Phase 3 practice results: Domain 1 — 91%, Domain 2 — 88%, Domain 3 — 61%, Domain 4 — 84%. What is the most strategically correct response?

- A) Average the scores and determine that 81% overall is sufficient to pass
- B) Allocate remaining study time primarily to Domain 3 since it is both the weakest and the highest-weighted domain
- C) Celebrate the strong performance across Domains 1, 2, and 4 and minimise Domain 3 review
- D) Submit the exam immediately since three of four domains exceed 85%

Answer: B Explanation: Correct Answer: B

Why Correct: Domain 3 is both the weakest performing domain AND the highest-weighted at 38%. A 61% score means ~13 questions wrong in Domain 3 alone. Targeted Domain 3 remediation provides the highest marginal improvement in overall scaled score.

Why Wrong: A — Simple averaging is misleading; a 61% on a 38% domain has disproportionate negative impact. C — Ignoring a 61% score on the highest-weight domain is high-risk. D — A 61% in Domain 3 makes passing very unlikely regardless of other domain scores.

Learning Insight: Performance tracking is only valuable if you act on it. A domain-level breakdown tells you exactly where to focus remediation.

Q5. A candidate with 8 weeks to prepare asks how to distribute study time. Which allocation best reflects the course's recommended approach?

- A) 2 weeks per domain (8 weeks total), allocating exactly equal time to each
- B) 2 weeks foundation (D1+D4), 2 weeks security operations (D2), 3 weeks attack/defence (D3), 1 week practice exams
- C) 1 week per section, totalling 26 weeks for complete coverage
- D) Spend all 8 weeks on Domain 3 since it carries the most weight

Answer: B Explanation: Correct Answer: B

Why Correct: This allocation mirrors the recommended Phase 1–4 study plan: foundation domains first, then security operations, then the heaviest domain with extended time, followed by integrated practice. It balances domain prerequisite order, weight, and exam readiness.

Why Wrong: A — Equal allocation ignores domain weighting; Domain 3 deserves more time than Domain 1. C — A 26-week plan risks topic staleness at the start. D — All-Domain-3 study neglects the foundational knowledge D3 requires from D1.

Learning Insight: Study plans must balance domain weight (where the marks are) and domain dependency (what must be learned before what).

Q6. The course includes bonus sections on low-code automation and CI/CD pipeline security. Is studying these sections necessary to pass the SecAI+ exam?

- A) Yes — CompTIA includes low-code automation questions in the Domain 3 section of the exam
- B) No — bonus sections cover job-ready skills beyond the exam objectives; valuable for career development but not required for certification
- C) Yes — CI/CD pipeline security is a major topic in Domain 2 and accounts for 10% of the exam
- D) No — bonus sections are only relevant for candidates applying for MLOps engineering roles

Answer: B Explanation: Correct Answer: B

Why Correct: Bonus sections explicitly extend beyond the SecAI+ exam objectives. They build practitioner-level, job-ready skills in rapidly evolving areas. They are valuable for career growth but not required for certification success.

Why Wrong: A — Low-code automation is a bonus topic, not a listed SecAI+ exam objective. C — CI/CD security is not listed as a primary Domain 2 exam objective with a specific weighting. D — Bonus sections are relevant to any AI security practitioner, not exclusively MLOps engineers.

Learning Insight: Prioritise the 26 core sections for the exam. Invest time in bonus sections after securing your certification, or if your timeline allows.

Q7. Which of the following responsibilities falls within the scope of Domain 4 (Governance, Risk, and Compliance)?

- A) Configuring input sanitisation controls to prevent prompt injection
- B) Performing vulnerability assessments on ML model training pipelines
- C) Ensuring AI systems comply with the EU AI Act and NIST AI RMF requirements
- D) Analysing adversarial examples to identify model evasion patterns

Answer: C Explanation: Correct Answer: C

Why Correct: Domain 4 covers organisational governance, responsible AI principles, risk management, and compliance with frameworks including the NIST AI RMF, EU AI Act, OECD AI Principles, and ISO/IEC 42001. Regulatory compliance assurance is a core Domain 4 responsibility.

Why Wrong: A — Input sanitisation for prompt injection is a compensating control — Domain 3 (Attack Vectors and Defence). B — Vulnerability assessment of ML pipelines is a Domain 2 (AI Security Operations) activity. D — Adversarial example analysis is a Domain 3 (Attack Vectors) activity.

Learning Insight: Mapping activities to domains is a critical SecAI+ exam skill. Domain 4 questions focus on policy, frameworks, roles, and organisational accountability — not hands-on technical security tasks.

Q8. Two SecAI+ certified candidates apply for an AI Security Operations role. Candidate A completed only the core 26 exam-aligned sections. Candidate B completed the core sections plus all bonus sections. Which is likely better prepared for the role?

- A) Candidate A — the core sections provide sufficient technical depth for any AI security role

- B) Candidate B — bonus sections cover practical job-ready skills (AI tools, automation, emerging threats) that core sections do not address
- C) Both candidates are equally prepared — certification validates identical competency
- D) Candidate A — bonus sections introduce topics not relevant to security operations roles

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct Answer: B

Why Correct: Bonus sections cover AI-enabled security tools, automation of security tasks, CI/CD pipeline security, and emerging threats — all directly applicable to security operations roles. Candidate B has broader job readiness.

Why Wrong: A — Core sections cover exam objectives; bonus sections cover practitioner skills real roles require. C — Certification validates knowledge equivalence but not study breadth. D — AI security tools, automation, and CI/CD security are directly relevant to operations roles.

Learning Insight: Certifications signal baseline competence. Bonus sections signal practitioner-level readiness. For competitive roles, going beyond the minimum is a differentiator.

Q9. Which cognitive learning principle makes flashcards particularly effective for retaining terminology and framework acronyms?

- A) Massed practice — reviewing all flashcards in a single long session maximises retention
- B) Spaced repetition — reviewing flashcards at increasing intervals over time exploits the spacing effect to strengthen long-term memory
- C) Passive review — reading flashcard content without active recall improves recognition
- D) Serial position effect — terms near the beginning and end of a flashcard deck are automatically remembered

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct Answer: B

Why Correct: Spaced repetition is one of the most evidence-supported memory enhancement techniques. Reviewing material at increasing intervals exploits the spacing effect, where retrieval strengthens long-term retention more than massed review.

Why Wrong: A — Massed practice produces rapid but shallow short-term retention. C — Passive reading without active recall is significantly less effective. D — The serial position effect applies to incidental memory; flashcard tools randomise card order to counteract it.

Learning Insight: Use a spaced repetition app for your flashcards rather than reviewing all cards every session. Set review intervals that increase as you demonstrate mastery of each card.

Q10. Which of the following activities would a student expect to study in the Domain 2 sections of this course?

- A) How transformer architectures learn from training data
- B) How to implement and test compensating controls against data poisoning
- C) How to detect anomalous activity in an AI system and initiate an incident response procedure
- D) How the EU AI Act classifies AI systems by risk level

Answer: C **Explanation:** Correct Answer: C

Why Correct: Domain 2 (AI Security Operations) covers incident detection, response, and recovery for AI-

related security events. Anomaly detection in AI systems and incident response workflows are core Domain 2 competencies.

Why Wrong: A — Transformer architecture learning is a Domain 1 foundational concept. B — Compensating controls against data poisoning is a Domain 3 topic. D — EU AI Act risk classification is a Domain 4 topic.

Learning Insight: Each domain has a distinct operational focus. Domain 2 is about running and securing AI systems in production.

Q11. A student scores 60% on a section quiz before reading the Student Resource Guide, then re-studies and scores 85%. What learning principle explains this improvement?

- A) The second quiz was easier than the first
- B) Active testing followed by targeted review (retrieval practice and feedback) strengthens memory encoding more than passive re-reading alone
- C) The student memorised the answers from the first quiz
- D) Section quizzes are designed to get progressively easier with each attempt

Answer: B Explanation: Correct Answer: B

Why Correct: The testing effect (retrieval practice effect) shows that attempting to recall information — even when failing — creates stronger memory traces than re-reading. The initial 60% quiz identifies specific gaps. Targeted review followed by a retest produces measurable improvement.

Why Wrong: A — The question states 'a similar quiz,' implying equivalent difficulty. C — The improvement mechanism described is targeted review, not answer memorisation. D — Quizzes in this course are not designed to decrease in difficulty.

Learning Insight: Failing a quiz is not a problem — it is a diagnostic. The improvement comes from targeted review of identified gaps, not from avoiding tests until you feel ready.

Q12. Which scenario best illustrates the application of Domain 3 knowledge on the job?

- A) Writing an AI governance policy document for the board of directors
- B) Identifying that an ML model's outputs have been manipulated by adversarially crafted input images and recommending input validation controls
- C) Configuring audit logging for a cloud-based AI inference service
- D) Reviewing a vendor's AI system against NIST AI RMF criteria

Answer: B Explanation: Correct Answer: B

Why Correct: Recognising adversarial examples and recommending input validation as a compensating control is a core Domain 3 competency. This spans both attack vector identification and defence recommendation.

Why Wrong: A — Writing governance policy documents is a Domain 4 responsibility. C — Configuring audit logging for a production AI service is a Domain 2 monitoring task. D — Reviewing vendor AI systems against NIST AI RMF is a Domain 4 third-party evaluation task.

Learning Insight: Domain 3 competency means you can identify attack techniques, explain how they exploit AI model weaknesses, and recommend controls to mitigate them.

Q13. Bonus sections on quantum computing threats appear near the end of the course. Why is this placement appropriate?

- A) Quantum computing is a Domain 1 foundational concept that is deliberately deferred
- B) Quantum threats extend beyond current exam objectives and require the full context of all four domains before they can be meaningfully applied
- C) CompTIA requires quantum computing content to be taught last as per exam blueprint sequencing
- D) Quantum computing is the most difficult topic and is placed last to prevent early discouragement

Answer: B Explanation: Correct Answer: B

Why Correct: Quantum computing threats intersect with AI security, cryptography, and governance frameworks. Understanding quantum's impact on AI security requires foundational knowledge of AI models (D1), security operations (D2), attack vectors (D3), and risk management (D4).

Why Wrong: A — Quantum computing is not a Domain 1 topic; it is an emerging threat category beyond the four core domains. C — CompTIA does not prescribe internal course sequencing for instructors. D — Difficulty is not the sequencing criterion; conceptual dependency is.

Learning Insight: Emerging threat topics always build on established foundations. Studying quantum threats before understanding the AI model lifecycle would produce disconnected knowledge.

Q14. The course states it is 'updated regularly' because 'AI security evolves fast.' What practical implication does this have for a candidate?

- A) The candidate must re-purchase the course every 6 months to access updated content
- B) The candidate should check whether section content has been updated since they last studied that topic, as new threats or framework changes may have altered exam-relevant content
- C) Updated courses automatically change the SecAI+ exam objectives, so the candidate must wait until updates are complete before studying
- D) Regular updates mean the course is still in development and not yet suitable for exam preparation

Answer: B Explanation: Correct Answer: B

Why Correct: AI security is a rapidly evolving field. Frameworks such as NIST AI RMF and the EU AI Act receive updates. A candidate who studied a section months ago should verify the content has not changed before the exam, particularly in Domain 3 and Domain 4.

Why Wrong: A — Course updates are typically included in the original purchase. C — Course updates do not change CompTIA's official exam objectives. D — Regular updates indicate an actively maintained, high-quality course.

Learning Insight: Subscribe to CompTIA's official exam objective update notifications and check the course's last-updated timestamp before your exam.

Q15. A candidate has completed all 26 core sections and all practice tools. What final readiness check most accurately predicts exam success?

- A) Completion of all 26 sections in the course platform

- B) Consistent scoring of 85% or higher across multiple full-length timed practice exams, with no single domain below 75%
- C) Having reviewed all Student Resource Guide glossaries at least once
- D) Completing the course community discussion forum with at least 10 posts

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct Answer: B

Why Correct: Full-length timed practice exam scores are the strongest predictor of actual exam performance. A consistent 85%+ overall score with no domain below 75% indicates both breadth of knowledge and the ability to perform under realistic time constraints.

Why Wrong: A — Section completion confirms exposure but not comprehension or application. C — Glossary review indicates terminology coverage but not scenario-based reasoning. D — Community participation contributes to learning but is not a measurable readiness indicator.

Learning Insight: Do not confuse activity metrics (sections completed, flashcards reviewed) with readiness metrics (timed practice exam scores by domain).

Q16. The course includes a section on AI security use cases across industries. Why are industry-specific examples included in a vendor-neutral certification course?

- A) CompTIA requires industry case studies to be included in all certification courses
- B) Industry-specific examples contextualise abstract security concepts, making them easier to understand, remember, and apply in job interviews and real roles
- C) The SecAI+ exam includes industry-specific questions requiring knowledge of healthcare and financial services AI deployments
- D) Industry examples are included to help candidates choose which industry to work in after passing the exam

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct Answer: B

Why Correct: Contextualising abstract concepts in recognisable real-world settings improves comprehension, retention, and transfer of knowledge. This is a standard instructional design technique for technical education.

Why Wrong: A — CompTIA does not mandate specific pedagogical approaches. C — The SecAI+ exam is vendor- and industry-neutral. D — Course content is designed to build competence, not to guide career choices.

Learning Insight: When studying industry examples, focus on the underlying security principle, not the industry details. The principle transfers across industries; the specific details do not appear on the exam.

Q17. Which statement accurately describes the relationship between section quizzes and full-length practice exams?

- A) Section quizzes and practice exams are interchangeable and serve the same purpose
- B) Section quizzes test focused topic understanding after each section; full-length practice exams test integrated knowledge and time management across all domains
- C) Full-length practice exams are harder versions of section quizzes and should be taken first
- D) Section quizzes are optional; only full-length practice exams contribute to exam readiness

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct Answer: B

Why Correct: Section quizzes (5 questions per section) provide immediate feedback on specific topic comprehension. Full-length practice exams (90 questions, timed) simulate actual exam conditions and test whether the candidate can integrate knowledge under time pressure. Both serve distinct purposes.

Why Wrong: A — Different lengths, scope, and purpose make them non-interchangeable. C — Full-length exams are not harder versions of section quizzes; they are different formats. D — Section quizzes are a primary tool for identifying topic-level gaps.

Learning Insight: Use section quizzes for diagnostic feedback during study. Use full-length practice exams as readiness assessments in the final weeks before the exam.

Q18. A candidate with no prior AI background is considering the SecAI+ certification. What is the correct advice based on the course's design?

- A) They should not attempt SecAI+ — CompTIA requires a minimum of 2 years of AI experience
- B) The course is designed to build from foundational AI concepts, making it accessible to candidates without a deep AI background, though general IT or security experience is helpful
- C) They should complete the CompTIA Security+ exam first as a mandatory prerequisite
- D) They should only study Domain 4 (Governance) since it requires the least technical background

Answer: B **Explanation:** Correct Answer: B

Why Correct: The course begins with Domain 1 (AI Fundamentals) specifically to build foundational knowledge for candidates new to AI. While general IT or security experience accelerates learning, the course is structured to be accessible from a non-AI background.

Why Wrong: A — CompTIA recommends experience but does not enforce it as a technical prerequisite. C — Security+ is a recommended starting point but is not a mandatory prerequisite for SecAI+. D — Domain 4 requires understanding of AI risks and frameworks, which depends on Domain 1 content.

Learning Insight: A motivated candidate without AI background who follows the course sequentially can absolutely succeed with consistent study.

Q19. Responsible AI principles including fairness, transparency, accountability, and explainability appear under which SecAI+ domain?

- A) Domain 1 — AI Fundamentals, as they describe how AI models should be designed
- B) Domain 2 — AI Security Operations, as they guide incident response decisions
- C) Domain 3 — AI Attack Vectors and Defence, as unfair or opaque AI is an attack surface
- D) Domain 4 — Governance, Risk, and Compliance, as they form the ethical and organisational governance framework for AI systems

Answer: D **Explanation:** Correct Answer: D

Why Correct: Responsible AI principles are governance and ethics frameworks that define how organisations should develop and deploy AI. These are covered in Domain 4 alongside other organisational governance frameworks and compliance standards.

Why Wrong: A — Domain 1 covers how AI models work technically, not ethical governance principles. B — Domain 2 covers operational security activities; responsible AI is a governance concept. C — While opaque AI creates attack surfaces, the principles of responsible AI are classified under governance.

Learning Insight: Expect exam questions on fairness, transparency, and explainability in Domain 4 context — policy, frameworks, and organisational roles, not technical controls.

Q20. A candidate completes the full course in 8 weeks and scores 82% overall on their final practice exam, with Domain 3 at 79%. Should they schedule the exam?

- A) Yes — 82% overall is well above the 750/900 passing score threshold
- B) Yes — 79% in Domain 3 combined with 82% overall provides sufficient confidence
- C) The decision is borderline — the recommended target is 85% overall; at 82% the candidate is close but without the full recommended safety margin; one more week of targeted Domain 3 review is advisable if time allows
- D) No — the exam cannot be scheduled until Domain 3 reaches 85%

Answer: C **Explanation:** Correct Answer: C

Why Correct: The recommended target is 85%+ overall to build a buffer against exam-day variability. At 82%, the candidate is 3 points below the recommended threshold. An additional week of targeted Domain 3 review could close the gap at low time cost.

Why Wrong: A — 82% is above the implied minimum (~80%) but below the recommended 85% safety buffer. B — 79% in Domain 3 is above the 75% by-domain minimum, but the overall 82% is below the recommended target. D — There is no hard rule that Domain 3 must reach 85%; the recommendation is a guideline.

Learning Insight: At 82%, the candidate has a reasonable chance of passing but takes on more risk than at 85%. If time pressure is low, one more week of targeted review is the rational choice.